Mission Statement

By Big Poppa E (Eirik Ott)

INTRODUCTION

You have a purpose in life. You know in your heart what's most important to you. In fact, your mission and values are expressed every day, by how you live–you just may not realize it. A personal mission statement provides clarity and gives you a sense of purpose. It defines who you are and how you will live. Eirik Ott also known as Big Poppa E has crafted one of the most amazing Mission Statements that I'd like to share with you today. It's not the Mission Statement for an organization or even for an individual, it is the Mission Statement for a group of people I hold in the hightest esteem . . . Poets. Mission Statement by Big Poppa E.

"We are poets.

And that lifestyle choice may have destroyed our credit, yes.

It may have destroyed relationships, yes.

It may have destroyed our backs from sleeping on couches

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between times when we could afford a place of our own, yes.

But, oh, the beauty. The soul. The whole wide world.

We live for that connection between a poet

and someone moved to touch their hand to their chest and whisper, "Oh."

Between two people sitting cross-legged on dusty wooden floors

bathed in Joni Mitchell and candlelight at 3am.

Heads bowed. Hands held. Knees touching.

Between the wind and a person alone at a bus stop whispering his truth over invisible turntable break-beats

from the shady confines of his hoodie.

It's all poetry. All of it.

Every single breath is scented with poetry.

We will die penniless, but oh the stories.

The love. The whole wide world held limp in the

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palms of our hands.
The smiles on our faces as we bid you all goodbye
with a twinkle in our eyes and so many sweet, sad
songs in our hearts.
So many people never get the chance to fly,
because they never have the courage to leap
blindingly, stupidly, floppingly out of the nest
and bash themselves against the branches all the
way down
then get up and do it again and again
so many times they feel like they'll die if they try
again,
but that's the only way to learn how to fly.
Every poet who has ever spread their wings and left
the bonds of this earth
has a body covered in scars and bruises
you feel in every word they speak.
We don't just write poetry.

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We live poetry.
Warm noses on cold windowpanes leave haiku in
frost.
Blank pages across foreheads yield truth.
We can cut our wrists on your lips and drip songs on
your tongues.
We can't help it.
We are poets.
People chain themselves to desks
and cage themselves in cubicles
and trade their precious hours on this planet
for scraps of paper and a gold watch and some
fleeting notion of security.
And we're the crazy ones?
Wasting time with moonbeams and seashores.
We're the irresponsible ones?
Chasing butterflies and making love on rooftops.
To hell with that!

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Poetry may be the rose colored glasses through
which we see the world,
but we get to see everything.
We are not allowed to close our eyes.
We do not have the right to remain silent.
We are hopelessly, painfully, ravishingly,
wonderfully, terribly, horribly
in love with love. And life itself.
Even when it hurts.
Even when we cry and beg for it all to end.
Even then it's all so very beautiful and real and
perfect.
And we carry sunshine in our chests.
Our rib cages cast shadows on the blind side of our
skin.
You can see ghosts dancing in our flesh if you
squint.
And we can guide ships to rocky shores

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just by toeing the lips of the ocean and spreading
our arms wide.
Our goal in life is simple.
To be.
Wide eyed and breathless at the wonders of the
world around us
and dance naked in the warm summer rain
and laugh and laugh
even when everything sucks.
Because we may not always be happy
and we may not always be right
and we may not always be beautiful.
But right here and right now we are all so young.
Young enough to be alive.
And all the stoplights are so green
they sprout tendrils that tickle the tops of passing
buses.
And the whole wide world is still so full of magic

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and possibility.

It would be an insult not to drink deeply of it.

That's what we do.

We drink deeply of life in full-throated gulps.

That's who we are.

We are poets."

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Big Poppa E (Eirik Ott)
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AWARD HISTORY

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